

Promises and Pressure: A Signal

承诺与压力：一个信号

Theme: 友谊、家庭与人际关系 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The map had taught them to measure a gate in a minute; it had not taught them how to be at home. The third arc opened at home, in a kitchen with a **fridge** that hummed like a small, unhappy **mule**. Lin's mother was a **textile** worker, a **daughter** of farmers, and the mother of a boy who was never at home. "You **reckon** you are busy," she said. "**Ensure** that you eat."

His **grandson** — his sister's boy — was doing a **biographical** project on an **actress** nobody in the family had heard of. The early pages would **reveal** a bad **score**, a **disastrous** first draft, and the name of a **granddaughter**; three notebooks do not **constitute** a **biography**, and she said so **whilst** stirring the soup. "It is a **thorough** piece of work," the boy said, "and it is a **disaster**." A **donkey** brayed in a field, and a **deer** and a **lioness** were on the poster above the sink. "A **tigress** is not a house cat," said the grandmother, "and neither is a **daughter**."

A **suspicious** neighbour, a **scary** story about a **shaver** left plugged in, and a **horrible** smell from the drain made the evening **eventful**. "Do not **behave** like a hero," his mother said. "**Negotiate**." The **Olympic** flag on the wall, faded by the sun, was the only decoration in the room, and the whole evening seemed to **revolve** around the cooker.

They talked about the **baby boom**, a **baby boomer** aunt, and a **cock** that crowed at four in the morning. "**Humanity** is not a **measurable** thing," she said, "and that is the **pity** of it." The **doom** of the small project was written into the timetable, and they both knew it. Any talk of plans was **tragically** short, and **joyous** only at the edges.

What astonished him was the rhythm of the household: a **rhythmic** clatter, a **humorous** remark, a bowl of white rice, and a lot of unspoken resentment. "Yes, sir," the boy said, when his grandfather asked whether he would help. "I would tell you to **centralize** your work," his mother said, "but your father could not do it either." The best teacher he ever had was a kid of nine, later a neighbour, who knew the difference between a mean remark and a pound of rice. He could not **amaze** her with a plan; he could only turn up, particularly on the bad days, and that was the increase she had asked for.

中文翻译

那张地图教会他们在一分钟里测完一道门；它没有教会他们如何待在家里。第三段弧线在家里开始，在一间厨房里，冰箱像一头不快活的小骡子那样嗡嗡作响。林伟的母亲是纺织工人、农民的女儿，也是一个从不在家的男孩的母亲。“你以为你很忙，”她说，“要保证吃饭。”

他的孙子——他姐姐家的男孩——正在做一个关于某位女演员的传记项目，而家里没人听过那个名字。开头几页会揭示一场可怕的惊吓、一份灾难性的初稿，以及一个孙女的名字；三个笔记本构不成一部传记，而她在搅汤的时候就是这么说的。“这是一份非常彻底的作业，”男孩说，“而且是一场灾难。”田里一头驴在叫，水槽上方的海报里有一头鹿和一头母狮。“母虎不是家猫，”祖母说，“女儿也不是。”

一个多疑的邻居、一个关于电动剃刀插着电的吓人故事，以及下水道传来的可怕气味，让这个傍晚多事。“不要表现得像个英雄，”他母亲说。“去谈。”墙上那面被太阳晒褪色的奥运旗帜是屋里唯一的装饰，而整个晚上似乎都绕着灶台旋转。

他们谈起婴儿潮、一位婴儿潮一代的姑妈，以及一只凌晨四点打鸣的公鸡。“人性不是可测量的东西，”她说，“而这正是可惜之处。”这个小项目的厄运写在时间表里，他们两人都知道。任何关于计划的谈话都短得悲惨，只在边缘处显得快乐。

让他惊讶的是这个家庭的节奏：一阵有节奏的响声、一句幽默的评论、一碗白米饭，以及许多没有说出口的怨恨。“是的，先生，”男孩在祖父问他是否愿意帮忙时说。“我本想告诉你要把工作集中起来，”他母亲说，“但你父亲也做不到。”他有过的最好的老师是一个九岁的孩子，后来成了邻居，他知道一句刻薄的话和一斤米之间的区别。他无法用一个计划让她惊叹；他只能在糟糕的日子里去出现——尤其是那些日子——而那正是她所要求的增加。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
daughter 'dɔ:tə POS: n	n. 女儿; a. 女儿的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a female human offspring
ensure in'ʃʊə POS: vt	vt. 确定, 保证, 担保, 保护; [经] 确保, 确定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make certain of; v. be careful or certain to do something; make certain of something
reveal ri'vi:l POS: vt	vt. 露出, 显示, 透露, 揭露, 泄露, (神) 启示; n. 窗侧, 门侧 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. disclose directly or through prophets
whilst waɪlst POS: conj	conj. 当...的时候, 和...同时, 虽然, 只要, 然而, 而, 尽管 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: adv. While.
reckon 'reken POS: vt	vt. 计算, 总计, 估计, 认为, 猜想; vi. 数, 计算, 估计, 依赖, 料想 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. take account of
constitute kən'stɪtjut POS: vt	vt. 构成, 组成, 任命; [建] 构造, 组成 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. form or compose
disaster di'zɑ:sstə POS: n	n. 灾祸, 不幸, 彻底失败 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an act that has disastrous consequences
behave bi'heɪv POS: vi	vi. 举止端正, 行为规矩; vt. 检点(自己的)行为, 使表现好 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. behave in a certain manner; v. behave well or properly
negotiate ni'gəʊʃieɪt POS: vi	vi. 商议, 谈判, 交涉; vt. 谈妥, 转让, 处理 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. succeed in passing through, around, or over
Olympic əʊ'lɪmpɪk POS: a	a. 奥林匹亚的, 奥林匹克山的, 强有力的, 巨大的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to the Olympic Games
deer diə POS: n	n. 鹿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. distinguished from Bovidae by the male's having solid deciduous antlers
actress 'æktrɪs POS: n	n. 女演员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a female actor
humanity hju:'mænɪti POS: n	n. 人性, 人类, 博爱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being humane
horrible 'hɒrəbl POS: a	a. 可怕的, 遭透的, 极讨厌的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. provoking horror
pity 'pɪti POS: n	n. 遗憾, 同情, 怜悯, 憾事, 可惜; vt. 同情, 怜悯; vi. 觉得可怜, 有同情心 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an unfortunate development
scare skeə POS: n	n. 惊吓, 恐慌; vt. 惊吓, 使恐慌; vi. 受惊 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sudden attack of fear
scary 'skeəri POS: a	a. 容易受惊的, 胆小的, 提心吊胆的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. provoking fear terror
suspicious sə'spiʃjəs POS: a	a. 可疑的, 多疑的, 怀疑的; [法] 怀疑的, 令人怀疑的, 可疑的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. openly distrustful and unwilling to confide; s. not as expected
textile 'tekstail POS: n	n. 纺织品, 纺织业; a. 织的, 纺织的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to fabrics or fabric making
biography baɪ'ɒɡrəfi POS: n	n. 传记 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an account of the series of events making up a person's life
thorough 'θʌrə POS: a	a. 十分的, 彻底的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. painstakingly careful and accurate
disastrous di'zɑ:stres POS: a	a. 损失惨重的, 悲伤的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. (of events) having extremely unfortunate or dire consequences; bringing ruin
fridge frɪdʒ POS: n	n. 电冰箱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a refrigerator in which the coolant is pumped around by an electric motor
mule mju:l POS: n	n. 骡, 倔强之人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. hybrid offspring of a male donkey and a female horse; usually sterile; n. a slipper that has no fitting aro...
grandson 'grændsʌn POS: n	n. 孙子, 外孙 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a male grandchild

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
donkey 'dɒŋki POS: n	n. 驴子, 笨蛋, 顽固者, 辅助发动机, 辅助泵 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the symbol of the Democratic Party; introduced in cartoons by Thomas Nast in 1874
revolve ri'vɒlv POS: v	v. (使)旋转, 反复考虑, 循环出现 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. turn on or around an axis or a center
doom du:m POS: n	n. 厄运, 不幸, 法律, 宣告, 判决, 死亡; vt. 命中注定, 判决 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an unpleasant or disastrous destiny; v. make certain of the failure or destruction of
cock kɒk POS: n	n. 公鸡, 雄禽, 龙头, 头目, 锥形小干草堆; vt. 使耸立, 使竖起, 堆成锥形小干草堆; vi. 大摇大摆地走, 翘起 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. obscene terms for penis; n. adult male chicken; n. adult male bird; v. tilt or slant to one side
granddaughter ˈgrændɔ:tə(r) POS: n	n. 孙女, 外孙女 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a female grandchild
amaze ə'meɪz POS: vt	vt. 使吃惊 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. affect with wonder
rhythmic 'rɪðmɪk POS: a	a. 有韵律的, 有节奏的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a recurring with measured regularity
humorous 'hju:mərəs POS: a	a. 富幽默感的, 滑稽的, 诙谐的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. full of or characterized by humor
biographical baɪəʊ'græfɪkəl POS: a	a. 传记的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a of or relating to or being biography
measurable 'meʒərəbl POS: a	a. 可测量的, 不久的, 重要的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. capable of being measured; s. of distinguished importance
joyous 'dʒɔɪəs POS: a	a. 快乐的, 高兴的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. full of or characterized by joy
tragically 'trædʒɪklɪ POS: adv	adv. 悲剧地, 悲惨地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in a tragic manner; with tragic consequences
astonish ə'stɒnɪʃ POS: vt	vt. 使惊讶 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v affect with wonder
centralize 'sentrəlaɪz POS: vt	vt. 集聚, 集中, 施行中央集权; vi. 集中 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make central
eventful i'ventfʊl POS: a	a. 变故多的, 多事的, 重要的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. full of events or incidents
lioness 'laɪənɪs POS: n	n. 雌狮 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a female lion
shaver 'ʃeɪvə POS: n	n. 修面的人, 电动剃刀, 刨刀, 杀价买进票的人, 善于讨价还价的人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an adult male who shaves; n. a razor powered by an electric motor
tigress 'taɪgrɪs POS: n	n. 母虎, 雌虎 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a female tiger
baby boom 'beɪbi bu:m POS: n	n. 生育高峰 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: No reliable source example available.
baby boomer 'beɪbi 'bu:mə POS: n	n. A person born during a baby boom, esp. one born in the U.S. betwee... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: No reliable source example available.